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QUALIFICATION TRAINING PACKAGE

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Chapter 1

OVERVIEW

1.1. Overview. This Qualification Training Package (QTP) establishes standardized training requirements and content for all Air Force and Space Force operators of passenger buses and related commercial motor vehicles (CMVs). Designed to ensure consistency and excellence across all installations, this package provides comprehensive guidance for both trainers and trainees throughout the process.

1.1.1. The training standards outlined herein align with Department of the Air Force (DAF) requirements that supplement the federal regulations, found within the *Commercial Driver's License (CDL) Manual* (American Association of Motor Vehicle Administrators (AAMVA)). This package serves as the authoritative source for curriculum development and performance evaluation. Trainers will utilize **Chapters 2** through **6** to guide trainee preparation, conduct classroom lectures, provide demonstrations, and administer knowledge and performance evaluations.

1.1.2. Trainees are required to read this entire lesson plan and the CDL Manual prior to starting lectures and must follow along with these materials during instruction. Successful completion of this training program demonstrates operator proficiency and supports mission readiness by maintaining the highest standards of safety, compliance, and operational effectiveness across both services.

1.2. Applicability. This QTP applies to Department of the Air Force personnel operating buses or similar CMVs. The testing and evaluation process is dictated by the installation's transition status to the AAMVA model.

1.2.1. Trainees assigned to an installation identified by AF/A4LR that has transitioned to the AAMVA model will complete written tests developed and administered in accordance with (IAW) Department of the Air Force Instruction (DAFI) 24-301, *Ground Transportation*, and QTP24-3-200, *Commercial Motor Vehicle Equivalent Program*. Following completion of the required knowledge tests, trainees must pass the Skills Test, which consists of three components: the Vehicle Inspection, Basic Control Skills, and Road Test.

1.2.2. Trainees assigned to an installation that has not transitioned to the AAMVA model will complete written tests developed locally and administered IAW DAFI 24-301. Subsequently, they will complete a localized Performance Test developed and administered by Training, Validation, and Operations (TVO) staff IAW DAFI 24-301 and this QTP.

1.2.3. The Ground Transportation (GT) TVO section manages oversight of these tests and updates operator records in the Online Vehicle Interactive Management System (OLVIMS).

1.3. Administrative. Send comments and suggested improvements on DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication* through Air Force Installation and Mission Support Center (AFIMSC) functional managers via e-mail at: AFIMSC.A34OG.GroundTrans@us.af.mil.

Chapter 2

RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Trainer. Provide an overview of training in **Chapter 2** and **3**. Deliver classroom lectures and conduct trainee preparation using the lesson plans in Section 4. Provide knowledge overview training per **Chapter 4** lesson plans. Conduct demonstration, performance, and evaluation activities per **Chapter 5**. At installations that have transitioned to the AAMVA model will coordinate with the VCO or designated authority and Unit Training Manager to schedule trainees for testing at the local E&TS or TCF for those requiring certification to operate buses, documented on DAF Form 2293, *U.S. Air Force Motor Vehicle Operator Identification Card*. For installations that have not transitioned to the AAMVA model, coordinate with the Ground Transportation TVO office for testing.

2.1.1. Review this QTP and Sections 1, 2, 4, and 5 of the CDL Manual, and applicable command and local directives with the trainee.

2.1.2. Conduct knowledge training with the trainees using this QTP and the CDL Manual.

2.1.3. Review the "Test Your Knowledge" questions from the CDL Manual with the trainee to ensure the required task knowledge has been gained to complete the task.

2.1.4. Conduct performance task explanation and demonstration using this QTP, the CDL Manual (AAMVA), and QTP24-3-200.

2.1.5. Verify completion of Section I and II on the Trainee's DAF Form 171, *Request for Driver Training and Addition to U.S. Government Driver's License*.

2.1.6. Upon completion of the applicable knowledge tests, ensures Section IV is completed by a certified TVOE on the Trainee's DAF Form 171 prior to executing any hands-on training.

2.1.7. Document and sign-off the task(s) in On-the-Job Training (OJT) records for 2T1X1 personnel.

2.2. Trainee. Read this QTP and Sections 1, 2, 4, and 5 of the CDL Manual prior to lecture. Complete the required knowledge test and skills or performance test identified in **Chapter 1**, ensuring all testing is requested through the designated authority. **Note:** Civilian personnel are required to meet local state/country licensing requirements and must review this QTP for Department of the Air Force requirements when operating a bus.

2.2.1. Review applicable command and installation guidance/directives to include state and local traffic laws for the transport of hazardous material on public roadways.

2.2.2. Ensure the trainer explains the QTP process and the trainee's responsibilities. Ask questions if you do not understand the objectives for each section or unit.

2.2.3. Complete the recommended training hours for the bus.

2.2.4. Must have a DAF Form 171 with Sections I and II completed, a state-issued driver's license, and a valid Common Access Card on their person when training. **Note:** Upon completion of the knowledge test, Section IV of DAF Form 171 must be completed by TVOE before hands-on training is conducted.

2.2.5. Pass the required, closed-book Knowledge Checks with an 80% or higher, and the performance test for the bus. The knowledge test consists of controlled test materials. Do not capture images, share, or discuss test questions with anyone, to include supervisors, UTMs, or other Airmen. Sharing formal test material is a 'test compromise' and is punishable under the Uniform Code of Military Justice.

2.2.6. For installations that have transitioned to the AAMVA model using the Education & Training Section (E&TS) or Test Control Facility (TCF) for knowledge testing, submit the certificate of training completion to the unit VCO or designated authority for submission to the local GT Operator Records & Licensing.

2.3. Ground Transportation TVO Section. Track the execution and completion of requirements IAW QTP 24-3-200. Provide certification support IAW DAFI 24-301 and QTP 24-3-200.

2.4. Vehicle Control Official (VCO) or Designated Authority.

2.4.1. Coordinate with the UTM to schedule trainees for knowledge tests. **Note:** In unique circumstances when CMVE electronic testing (e.g., *General Knowledge Test*) is unavailable at E&TS or TCF, coordinate with GT TVO Section for manual testing procedures.

2.4.1.1. For installations that have not transitioned to the AAMVA model, coordinate with the GT TVO Section for both knowledge and performance tests.

2.4.2. Ensure all test results are documented on DAF Form 171. **Note:** VCO will obtain a hard copy or electronic copy of test results for verification/record from the UTM or trainer.

2.4.3. Coordinate with GT TVO Section to schedule Skills Tests once hands-on training is complete.

Chapter 3

INTRODUCTION

3.1. Objectives. Upon completion of lectures and demonstrations, trainees will successfully meet all training requirements outlined in **Chapter 4**. This training ensures each trainee is a qualified operator for the ground transportation of passengers, possessing the necessary knowledge and skills for safe and professional passenger movement.

3.2. Desired Learning Outcome.

3.1.1. Understand the safety precautions to be followed pre-, during-, and post-operation of the bus and the air brake system.

3.1.2. Understand the purpose of the bus and its role in the mission.

3.1.3. Know the proper operator maintenance procedures of the bus, IAW the manufacturer's operator's manual, the seven-step inspection process and the vehicle inspection guide.

3.1.4. Safely and proficiently operate a bus.

3.3. Lesson Duration. Recommended instructional and hands on training time is 52.75 hours:

Figure 3.1. Recommended Training Time for Training Activities.

Training Activity	Training Time
Trainee's Preparation	5 Hours
Instructor's Lecture	5 Hours
Trainee's Written Evaluation	4 Hours
Instructor's Demonstration	5 Hours
Trainee's Personal Experience (to build confidence and proficiency): ▪ Perform Operator Maintenance ▪ Operating the Vehicle	30 Hours
Trainee's Performance Evaluation	3.75 Hours

3.4. Instructional References.

3.3.1. Bus Lesson Plan.

3.3.2. CDL Manual. Contact the GT TVO Section to obtain a copy.

3.3.3. Risk Management (RM) and Safety Principles IAW DAFI 90-802, *Risk Management* and Department of the Air Force Manual 90-803 *Risk Management (RM) Guidelines and Tools*.

3.3.4. Applicable Technical Orders (TOs) or Manufacturer's Operator's Manual(s)

(see Vehicle Management for TO number for vehicle being used in training).

3.3.5. Code of Federal Regulations (CFR), Title 49—Transportation, Subtitle B—Other Regulations Relating to Transportation (Continued), Chapter III—Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration (FMCSA), US Department of Transportation (USDOT), Parts 300-399.

3.3.6. USDOT, FMCSA; on-line at https://www.fmcsa.dot.gov/.

3.3.7. AAMVA website; on-line at http://www.aamva.org/.

3.5. Instructional Training Aids and Equipment.

3.1.2. Bus Lesson Plan.

3.1.3. CDL Manual.

3.1.4. Bus.

3.1.5. Applicable TO or manufacturer's operator's manual.

3.1.6. Suitable training area.

3.1.7. Traffic cones.

Chapter 4

KNOWLEDGE OVERVIEW AND OPERATIONAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1. Knowledge Overview and Testing Protocols. Trainees must successfully pass all required written evaluations with a minimum score of 80% IAW DAFI 24-301 prior to taking the performance test. These knowledge tests are closed book and are developed using this QTP and the CDL Manual as source documents. Prior to scheduling examinations, the trainer will validate that the trainee is prepared for official testing by conducting a comprehensive review of the "Test Your Knowledge" questions found within the CDL Manual. Upon validation, trainers will coordinate with the VCO or the TVO Section to schedule examinations. In the event of a test failure, the trainee will undergo remedial training at the discretion of the VCO and trainer before being rescheduled for re-evaluation.

Table 4.1. Knowledge Validation Summary.

Step	Action	Responsibility
1. Preparation	Review QTP & CDL Manual	Trainee/Trainer
2. Validation	Review “Test Your Knowledge” questions	Trainer
3. Scheduling	Coordinate with VCO or TVO Section for exams	Trainer
4. Examination	Complete applicable knowledge tests (min. 80% score)	Trainee

4.2. Regulatory Compliance and CDL Overview. While military members operating CMVs for military purposes are exempt from federal CDL requirements IAW 49 CFR Part 383.3, the Department of the Air Force strictly adheres to Department of Defense Manual (DoDM) 4500.36, *Acquisition, Management, and Use of DoD Non-Tactical Vehicles*. This mandate requires the military to develop and provide training that meets or exceeds the national requirements issued by the Secretary of Transportation. Therefore, the standards established by the FMCSA and AAMVA serve as the foundational curriculum for safe vehicle operations, basic control skills, and air brake systems within this package.

4.3. Bus Service, Mission Role, and Design. The primary purpose of the bus is to provide safe, reliable passenger transportation supporting base, unit, community (e.g., natural disasters), and broader Air Force missions. Services range from general mass transit and emergency support to transporting dependent school children. The Air Force utilizes a variety of buses, typically categorized as Type A (Surrey/Mini-bus, Gross Vehicle Weight Rating (GVWR) < 10,000 lbs.), Type C (Conventional/School bus, GVWR > 26,000 lbs.), and Type D (Transit/Cab Over, GVWR > 26,000 lbs.). Operation of any bus transporting 16 or more passengers requires a (P) Endorsement on DAF Form 2293. See **Figure 4.1.**, **Figure 4.2.**, and **Figure 4.3.** for examples of these types of buses.

Figure 4.1. Type A – Surrey.



Figure 4.2. Type C – Conventional.



Figure 4.3. Type D – Transit.



Table 4.2. Characteristics of Common Air Force Bus Types.

Characteristics of Common Air Force Bus Types		
Characteristic	**28 Passenger Bus**	**44 Passenger Bus**
Height	10-11’	10-11’
Width	8’	8’
Length	27’	36’
Fuel Type	Diesel	Diesel
Fuel Capacity	35 Gallons	50 Gallons
Passenger Capability	28 Passengers	44 Passengers
GVWR	33,000 lbs.	34,200 lbs.
Gross Axle Weight Rating (Front/Rear)	12,000/21,000 lbs.	13,200/21,000 lbs.

4.4. Vehicle Safety, Inspection, and Equipment. Operators are responsible for the safety and comfort of passengers, pre- and post-trip inspections, maintaining discipline, and executing emergency evacuations. Operators must utilize appropriate safety equipment, which may include

safety footwear, reflective belts, warning triangles, and first aid kits.

4.4.1. DAF Form 1800, *Operator's Inspection Guide and Trouble Report*. For day-to-day operations, the DAF Form 1800 will be used to document any discrepancies found during pre-use, during-use, and post-operation inspections. However, during the certification Performance Test, the trainee will not use the DAF Form 1800; they will only be permitted to reference the approved vehicle inspection guide while conducting the walk-around inspection, IAW QTP24-3-200.

4.5. Bus Operation and Driving Precautions. Trainees must master basic vehicle control, reference-point driving, steering, braking, backing, and shifting as extensively detailed in the CDL Manual. Operators must never exceed the posted speed limit and must constantly adjust to weather, road conditions, and passenger loads. The use of headsets is strictly prohibited, and in-cab noise must be controlled to ensure the operator can hear warning signals. Additionally, fueling with passengers on board, refueling in closed buildings, and towing the bus with passengers inside are strictly prohibited practices.

4.5.1. Passenger Transport and Danger Zones. Safe loading and unloading procedures are critical. Trainees must familiarize themselves with the CDL Manual protocols regarding blind spots, danger zones, the proper use of flashing warning lights, and railroad crossing procedures (e.g., all buses must stop at highway/rail grade crossings whether carrying passengers or not). Baggage must be secured to avoid shifting and cannot obstruct aisles or doors. Except for specific emergency supplies or authorized Other Regulated Material - Domestic small arms ammunition, hazardous materials are strictly prohibited in the passenger compartment.

4.5.2. Force Protection and Local Operations. Operating an Air Force bus requires situational awareness beyond standard traffic laws. Depending on the Force Protection Condition (FPCON), operators may be required to check passenger identification or conduct security sweeps of the bus for suspicious items. If operating on the flightline, operators must additionally comply with DAFI 13-213, *Airfield Driving*.

4.6. Air Brakes System and Inspection. Safe operation of a CMV equipped with air brakes requires comprehensive knowledge of system nomenclature, the dangers of contaminated air supply, and the ability to detect defects. Trainees will utilize the CDL Manual to understand these systems. During the daily walk-around inspection and the official Performance Test, operators must integrate specific air brake checks into the standard Seven-Step Inspection Process.

4.7. Medical Ambulance Bus. An ambulance bus is a type of ambulance used to transport and treat multiple patients who require ambulance-level care. Ambulance buses have been used for a number of different purposes, including mass casualty incident response, disaster response, large events and others who require non-ambulatory transport.

4.7.1. Designed to triage, treat, and transport up to 20-24 patients at a time using stretchers, beds, or secure wheelchair areas.

4.7.2. They act as mobile intensive care units or rehab stations for first responders during hurricanes, floods, or large fires.

4.7.3. Ambulance Buses are not considered emergency response vehicles, even when equipped with lights and sirens. These vehicles are designed to support mass movement of personnel requiring medical treatment and not for emergency responses (first responder).

Chapter 5

TRAINER EXPLANATION AND DEMONSTRATION

5.1. Trainer Preparation and Safety Protocols. Prior to beginning practical instruction, the trainer must establish a safe training location, reserve an appropriate vehicle, obtain the manufacturer's operator's manual, and ensure the trainee has a properly documented DAF Form 171. Both trainer and trainee must adhere to strict safety protocols, including the removal of jewelry and identification tags, the use of wheel chocks when parked, and the mandatory use of seatbelts.

5.1.1. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) and Risk Management. Trainers and trainees must ensure proper safety equipment is available; first aid kits, warning triangles, and (if required by local conditions) reflective belts, hearing protection, and inclement weather gear. Throughout the demonstration, the trainer will model the five-step Air Force Risk Management (RM) process: identify hazards, assess hazards, develop controls and make decisions, implement controls, and supervise/evaluate.

5.2. Operator Maintenance and Vehicle Pre-Trip Inspection. The trainer will conduct a comprehensive walk-around vehicle inspection alongside the trainee to familiarize them with all warning labels, capacities, and vehicle controls. The trainer will demonstrate the mandated inspection method and properly document the inspection on a DAF Form 1800.

5.2.1. Memory Aid Usage: The trainer will introduce the appropriate vehicle inspection guide/memory aid. Depending on the installation's transition status to the AAMVA model, this will be either the memory aid provided in the CDL Manual or the locally developed TVO memory aid. The trainer must ensure the trainee understands how to use it, as they will be permitted to reference a clean copy of their location's specific memory aid during the official evaluation.

5.3. Operational Demonstration. The trainer will demonstrate the safe operation of the bus, emphasizing reference-point driving, the proper use of warning lights, and passenger safety systems (e.g., handholds, floor coverings, signaling devices, and all emergency exits).

5.3.1. Basic Control Skills and Road Operations. The trainer will demonstrate the basic control skills and road course maneuvers. These maneuvers will align with either the CDL Manual or the locally developed TVO requirements, depending on the installation's status. This includes various backing maneuvers, navigating intersections, curves, upgrades/downgrades, and railroad crossings.

5.3.1.1. Air Force Specific Mandate: The trainer must explicitly emphasize that Air Force regulations always require the use of a spotter when backing a bus except when conducting training or certification in a secured location with no traffic. The operator must maintain visual contact with the spotter; if visual contact is lost, the operator must stop the vehicle immediately.

5.3.2. Passenger Transport and Post-Operation. The trainer will demonstrate or thoroughly explain safe passenger loading and unloading procedures (maximizing curbside operations) and emergency evacuation protocols. Finally, the trainer will demonstrate post-operation procedures, including proper shutdown, cleaning the vehicle, stowing cargo straps, draining air tanks (if applicable), refueling, and properly securing the vehicle by applying brakes and placing the transmission in neutral or park.

Chapter 6

TRAINEE PERFORMANCE DEMONSTRATION AND PERFORMANCE TEST

6.1. Performance Evaluation Framework. Following the trainer's demonstration, the trainee will transition to behind-the-wheel operation to build proficiency. The performance/skills test administered will be dictated by the installation's testing model:

6.1.1. AAMVA Model Installations: The official Air Force Skills Test, developed and administered in accordance with AAMVA standards, is the sole evaluation used to license the individual on CMVE assets.

6.1.2. Non-AAMVA Model Installations: A localized Performance Test, developed and administered by the GT TVO staff, will be utilized.

6.2. Trainee Preparation, Safety, and RM. The instructor must verify the training location, vehicle reservation, operator's manual, and DAF Form 171. The trainee is responsible for mirroring the safety protocols established in **Chapter 5**. This includes removing snag hazards (jewelry/tags), utilizing seatbelts, adjusting mirrors/seats before moving, and actively applying the five-step Air Force Risk Management (RM) process throughout their driving execution.

6.3. Trainee Vehicle Inspection Execution. The trainee will independently accomplish the pre-trip vehicle inspection. During standard training and daily operations, the trainee must document this inspection on the DAF Form 1800. However, during the official Performance Test, the trainee will not be required to complete the DAF Form 1800. They will be evaluated purely on their physical inspection and verbal explanations, utilizing a clean copy of the applicable memory aid (either the CDL Manual version or the locally developed GT TVO version).

6.4. Trainee Operational Execution. The trainee will demonstrate their ability to safely operate within the training area and on a road course. The trainee must effectively explain vehicle capacities, parking brakes, controls, and warning systems.

6.4.1. Maneuvers and Safety Adherence. The trainee will perform the required basic vehicle control skills as defined by their installation's specific testing criteria (AAMVA or local TVO). The trainee must utilize a spotter during all backing maneuvers. On the road course, the trainee must safely navigate turns, intersections, expressways, urban areas, varying grades, and railroad crossings while maintaining proper reference points and speed control.

6.4.1.1. At all times during the test, the trainee must drive in a safe and responsible manner; you must wear your safety belt, obey all traffic signs, signals, and laws, complete the test without an accident or moving violation. Any violation of these areas will result in an automatic No-Go for the performance test.

6.4.2. Post-Operation. Trainee will independently execute all post-operation responsibilities: conducting a walk-around inspection, cleaning the interior, stowing equipment, refueling, draining air tanks, and executing proper manufacturer shutdown and parking procedures.

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

Commercial Driver's License (CDL) Manual, American Association of Motor Vehicle Operators, 19 September 2025

DAFI 13-213, *Airfield Driving*, 4 February 2020

DAFI 24-301, *Ground Transportation*, 9 January 2026

DoDM 4500.36, *Acquisition, Management, and Use of DoD Non-Tactical Vehicles*, 7 July 2015

QTP 24-3-200, *Commercial Motor Vehicle Equivalent Program*, 25 March 2026

Title 49 CFR Parts 300-399, *Federal Motor Carriers*, 23 August 2013

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 171, *Request for Driver's Training and Addition to U.S. Government Driver's License*, 1 November 2018

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*, 22 September 2009

DAF Form 1800, *Operator's Inspection Guide and Trouble Report*, 1 April 2010

DAF Form 2293, *Motor Vehicle Operator Identification Card*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AAMVA—American Association of Motor Vehicle Administrators

AFIMSC—Air Force Installation Mission and Support Center

CDL—Commercial Driver's License

CFR—Code of Federal Regulations

CMV—Commercial Motor Vehicle

CMVE—Commercial Motor Vehicle Equivalent

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DoD—Department of Defense

DoDM—Department of Defense Manual

E&TS—Education & Training Section

FMCSA—Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration

FPCON—Force Protection Condition

GT—Ground Transportation

GVWR—Gross Vehicle Weight Rating

IAW—In Accordance With

OJT—On-the-Job Training

OLVIMS—Online Vehicle Interactive Management System

PPE—Personal Protective Equipment

QTP—Qualification Training Package

RM—Risk Management

TCF—Test Control Facility

TO—Technical Order

TVO—Training, Validation, and Operations

USDOT—United States Department of Transportation

UTM—Unit Training Manager

VCO—Vehicle Control Official